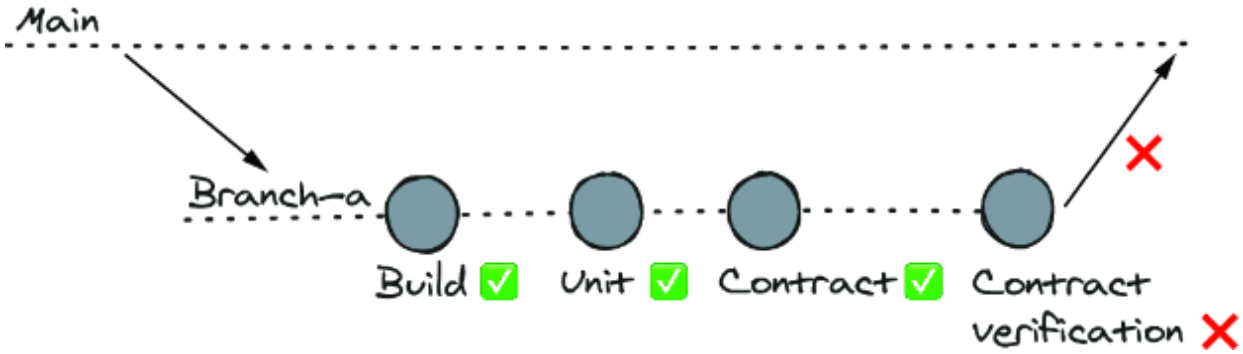


Figure 2.3 Consumer build pipeline with contract verification from the provider service. If there are breaking changes, the build pipeline won't continue.

Contract testing is a process that works best when there is open communication and agreement between teams. Following the same agreements between teams enhances the contract testing process. To avoid situations where the value of contract testing isn't properly used, we'll guide you step-by-step to understand how contract testing integrates into the broader testing strategy as part of this chapter. We'll clarify whether contract testing is a replacement for other forms of testing such as integration or E2E, and provide more additional benefits that it can offer when implemented correctly. Furthermore, we'll provide some guidance for persuading multiple teams to collaborate in contract testing, as well as address the challenges that may arise during the introduction and implementation of contract testing. Finally, we'll look into providing you a practical guide of introducing contract testing to your teams.

2.1 Contract testing and other testing types

Many engineers, specifically software developers or software development engineers in test (SDET), rely on the test automation pyramid, a popular guideline for implementing automated tests. The test automation pyramid has gained significant attention across the industry, offering a structured approach to test automation. While various versions of the test automation pyramid exist, we'll only focus on the original version proposed by Mike Cohn, as we've illustrated in figure 2.4.